NATIONAL GOVERNMENT
CONSTITUENCIES DEVELOPMENT FUND BOARD

Office of the Chief Executive Officer

OCEO Guide for Heads of Department

A step-by-step guide to activity memos, workplans and budgets, and activity reports in the Field Activity Planning and Monitoring system

Head of Department	Assistant Chief of Staff	Chief of Staff	CEO	Finance and Procurement

Institution	National Government Constituencies Development Fund Board
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1. Introduction

HEAD OF DEPARTMENT	You prepare your department's activity memos, keep its workplan and budget, add your officers to the staff list, and report on each activity after it ends.

1.1 What OCEO is for

OCEO is the system the Office of the CEO uses to plan, approve and follow up the Board's field activities. Every activity that takes officers out of the office starts as an **activity memo**. The memo says what the activity is, where and when it happens, who goes and what it costs. It is reviewed, decided by the CEO, carried out, and closed with a report.

Before OCEO, these memos moved on paper and by email. Now each memo has one record that shows who did what and when, its budget is checked against your approved allocation, and the officers on it are checked so nobody is sent to two places on the same day.

1.2 What you can and cannot see

OCEO is confidential. As a Head of Department you see your own department's work only.

You can	You cannot
Prepare, submit and follow your department's memos	See another department's memos or budget
Prepare your department's workplan and budget estimates	Approve a budget or change an approved one
See your department's budget position on your memos	Open the dashboard, register, calendar or reports
Add officers to the staff list	Deactivate an officer or change anyone's position or access
Act on instructions the CEO sends your department	Approve, decline or forward a memo

> **Warning:** Never share your password or let someone else use your account. Everything you open, print or download is recorded in the access log, under your name.

1.3 Who is involved

Who	What they do with your memo
You, the Head of Department	Prepare the memo, its team and costs, and submit it. Correct it if it is returned. Report after the activity.
An officer you choose	Can prepare a memo for you through a secure link, without an account (Section 12).
Assistant Chief of Staff	Reviews the memo. Returns it to you for correction, or forwards it.
Chief of Staff	Reviews the memo, and receives the Assistant's memos before they go to the CEO when that rule is on. Follows the activity and accepts the report.
Chief Executive Officer	Approves or declines the memo. On approval, instructs Finance, Procurement and any other department that must act.
Heads of instructed departments	Process the imprest, buy the tickets, or do what the CEO's instruction asks, and record a reference when done.

1.4 How to use this guide

Read Section 2 first: it shows the whole journey of a memo in one picture. Section 3 gets you signed in. After that, go straight to the section for the task in front of you.

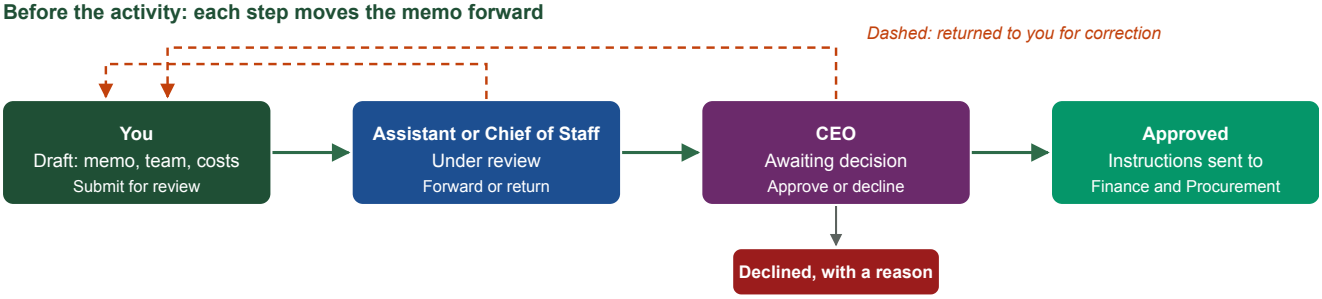
If you want to	Read
Sign in for the first time, or reset your password	Section 3
Add a missing officer	Section 4
Prepare your workplan and budget for the year	Section 5
Send a memo for an activity	Sections 6, 7 and 8
Deal with a memo that came back to you	Section 9
Submit the report after the activity	Section 11
Have an officer draft a memo for you	Section 12
Act on an instruction from the CEO	Section 13

Screen labels, menu items and buttons are printed in **green bold**, exactly as they appear in OCEO. The appendices hold the memo tabs, checklists to use before you submit, answers to common questions, and who to contact.

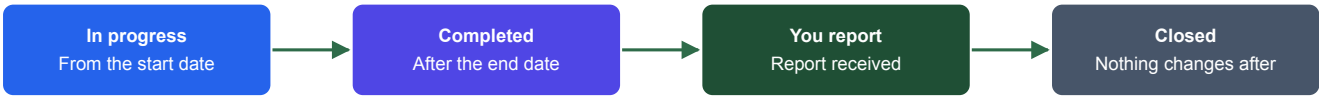
2. How a Memo Moves

2.1 The journey at a glance

Before the activity: each step moves the memo forward



After approval: the activity takes place and is closed



There is no direct route to the CEO: every memo is reviewed first. A returned memo goes back to the same office when you resubmit it.

2.2 Statuses you will see

The coloured badge on each memo shows where it is. These are the statuses a Head of Department meets:

Status	Who holds it	What it means
Draft	You	Being prepared. Only you can see it. You can still discard it.
With the Head of Department	You	An officer prepared it for you and sent it to you to check (Section 12).
Returned to the preparer	Your officer	You sent an officer's draft back to them to correct.
Under review	Assistant or Chief of Staff	Submitted and being reviewed. Locked for you.
Returned for correction	You	A reviewer or the CEO wants a change. Read the comment, correct and resubmit.
Awaiting decision	CEO	Reviewed and forwarded. The CEO will approve or decline it.
Returned	Office of the CEO	The CEO asked the reviewers for clarification. It may come on to you.
Approved	Nobody	Approved by the CEO. The instructed departments are acting on it.
Declined	Nobody (final)	Not approved. The CEO's reason is shown on the memo.
In progress	The team	The activity has started.
Completed	You	The activity has ended. Your report is now due.
Report received	Office of the CEO	Your report is in and being checked.
Closed	Nobody (final)	The report was accepted. Nothing on the memo can change.
Postponed or Cancelled	Office of the CEO	The activity was put off or called off by the Office of the CEO.

2.3 Rules that always apply

- **Every memo is reviewed** by the Assistant Chief of Staff or the Chief of Staff before it reaches the CEO.
- **Nothing is deleted after you submit.** A draft can be discarded. A submitted memo can only be returned, declined, postponed or cancelled, and its history stays.
- **Only an approved budget counts.** A memo is charged to a line in your department's approved budget.
- **An officer cannot be in two places at once.** Officers on an approved activity cannot be put on another one on the same days.
- **Comments are kept as written.** Review comments and the CEO's reasons cannot be edited or removed.

3. Getting Started

3.1 Your first sign-in

When you are appointed Head of Department, OCEO emails you a link to set your own password. The email has the subject **OCEO: set your password** and goes to your email address on the staff list.

1. Open the email and press the button in it. The link expires after a while, so use it soon.
2. Type a new password twice and press **Reset password**. Choose one you do not use anywhere else.
3. On the sign-in page, type your email and new password and press **Sign in**.
4. The first time only, read the NG-CDF Board Data Privacy Statement, tick to agree and accept it.

> **Tip:** No email? Look in your spam or junk folder first. If it is not there, ask the System Administrator to check your email on the staff list and press **Email password link** on your account to send a new one.

3.2 Two-factor sign-in

OCEO may ask you to protect your account with a second step. Install an authenticator app on your phone (for example Google Authenticator or Microsoft Authenticator), scan the code OCEO shows, and type the six-digit number from the app. Keep the recovery codes OCEO gives you somewhere safe. From then on, OCEO asks for the number from your phone each time you sign in.

3.3 Forgotten password or locked account

1. On the sign-in page press **Forgot password?**
2. Type your work email and press **Send reset link**.
3. Open the email, set a new password and sign in.

The page gives the same answer whatever email you type, so nobody can use it to find out who has an account. After several wrong passwords your account is locked for a while. Resetting your password unlocks it at once.

3.4 Finding your way

The menu on the left shows only what you use:

Menu	What you do there
Activity memos	Prepare memos, follow them through review and decision, and submit activity reports. The number beside it counts the memos that need you.
Staff list	Find and add the officers of your department.
Workplan and budget	Prepare your department's workplan and budget for the year and send it to the CEO.
Instructions	Shown only to departments the CEO instructs, such as Finance and Supply Chain (Section 13).

Press your name at the top right to see your profile, change your password, manage two-factor sign-in, or **Sign out**. Always sign out when you leave your computer.

3.5 Alerts, emails and SMS

The **bell** at the top of every page lists your alerts, for example when a memo is returned to you, approved or declined. While OCEO is open, a small pop-up also appears as each new alert arrives. Press an alert to go straight to the memo.

When something needs you to act, you also receive an email and, if your mobile number is on the staff list, an SMS. For confidentiality these give only the memo reference and the step. Sign in to see the details, and do not forward them.

4. Your Staff List

Only officers on the staff list can be put on a team. Human Resources loads most of the list. If an officer of your department is missing, you can add them.

4.1 Adding an officer

1. Open **Staff list** and search for the officer by name or PF number, to be sure they are not already there.
2. Press **Add officer**.
3. Fill in the name, PF number, designation, employment type, job grade, official email and mobile number.
4. Press **Save**.

> **Important:** The job grade sets the officer's DSA rate, so take it from HR's records. Casual staff are on scale 10. Attachees without a grade are on INTERN. Type mobile numbers as Kenyan numbers, for example 0712 345 678.

4.2 Importing a list

1. On **Staff list** press **Import** and choose your filled-in staff file.
2. Press **Check file**. OCEO shows how many officers would be added and lists any row with a problem.
3. Correct the file if needed, then import it.

4.3 What you cannot change

You can correct the officers you added yourself. You cannot deactivate an officer, or change anyone's department, designation or system access. When an officer leaves, transfers or is promoted, inform Human Resources or the System Administrator, who record the change with its date.

5. Your Workplan and Budget

Each financial year (July to June) your department prepares a workplan with its budget estimates. When the CEO approves it, it becomes your department's budget, and your memos are charged to its lines.

5.1 Preparing the workplan

1. Open **Workplan and budget** and choose the financial year at the top.
2. To prepare it in Excel, press **Workplan template**, fill it in and save it.
3. Press **Prepare or import the workplan**. Choose your file under **Workplan in Excel**, or leave it empty to type the lines in.
4. For each line, check the objective, deliverables, quantity and unit cost, quarters and responsible officer.
5. Fill in the **Objectives for the year**. You may attach the workplan document too.

> **Tip:** If the import finds a mistake, such as a quarter written as Q5, nothing is imported and the message names the row. Correct the file and import it again.

5.2 Submitting it to the CEO

Press **Submit to the CEO** and confirm. The lines are then locked while the CEO reviews them. The budget does not count until it is approved.

5.3 When the CEO returns it

The CEO may comment on the workplan or on a line, change a line's amount, or return it to you. You are alerted, and the badge on **Workplan and budget** shows it.

1. Open the workplan and read the orange box and the comments on the lines.
2. Make the changes asked for.
3. Press **Resubmit to the CEO**.

Your proposed amounts stay visible beside any the CEO changed, and every step is kept in the **Review history**.

5.4 After approval

Once approved, the lines no longer change. If you need more on a line, or to move money between lines, ask the Office of the CEO: they handle budget adjustments, and the CEO approves them.

6. Preparing an Activity Memo

6.1 Before you start

Have these ready
☐ Your department's memo reference number (REF NO) and the date of the memo
☐ The dates, the number of days, and the county, constituency and venue
☐ The officers who will go, all on the staff list with the right job grade
☐ The line in your approved budget the activity is charged to
☐ The other costs: tickets, fuel, vehicle hire, venue and so on

6.2 Creating the memo

1. Open **Activity memos** and press **Create new activity memo**.
2. Fill in the form, using the table in 6.3.
3. Press **Save draft**. You can return to it any time from the **Drafts** tab.

6.3 Filling in the form

Part of the form	What to put
Title and purpose	A short, clear title, and one sentence on what the activity is for.
Category and activity type	Choose the closest from the lists.
Introduction and justification	Why the activity is needed, and why now. Add other sections, such as a programme, under **More memo sections**.
Key risks	Anything that could stop the activity or raise its cost.
Memo reference (REF NO) and date issued	Your department's reference and the memo date. Both are required before you can submit.
Planned start and number of days	The first day and how many days. OCEO works out the nights for DSA.
Locations	County, constituency and venue. Press **Add location** for more places.
Budget line and estimate	The line in your approved budget, and your estimate of the total.

6.4 Choosing the budget line

When you choose the budget line, OCEO shows your department's **budget position**:

Figure	What it means
Allocation	Your approved budget, with any approved adjustments.
Spent	What activity reports show was actually spent.
Committed	Planned costs of approved memos not yet reported.
Pending	Memos still in review. Shown for information; not taken off the balance.
Balance	Allocation, less spent and committed. What is still available.

> **Note:** If no allocation shows, your workplan and budget for the year has not been approved yet. If the balance is too low for the activity, speak to the Office of the CEO before you submit.

7. Adding the Team and Costs

On the saved memo, press **Team and costs**.

7.1 Adding officers

1. Press **Add officers**.
2. Search by name, or filter by department and press **Select all shown**.
3. Tick the officers, choose their role (for example **Team lead** or **Member**) and press **Add to team**.

OCEO adds each officer's DSA automatically from their job grade and the number of nights.

7.2 External participants and groups

- For a person from outside the Board, press **Add external participant**.
- For many people you do not need to name, such as 40 youth at a forum, press **Add a group by number**, give the group a name and the headcount, and choose one DSA scale.

7.3 Cost lines

Press **Add cost line** for anything other than DSA: air tickets, bus fare, fuel, vehicle hire, venue, materials. Choose the cost type, describe it and type the amount. If a ticket is for one officer, choose that officer.

7.4 How DSA is worked out

- There is one daily rate per job grade, wherever in Kenya the activity takes place.
- An activity of **two days or more** pays the night before the start (for travel) and every night up to the end: the number of days plus one.
- A **one-day** activity pays no nights.

Example	Nights paid	Scale 6 officer	Casual (scale 10)
One-day meeting	0	0.00	0.00
Three-day visit	4	4 × 11,200 = 44,800.00	4 × 6,300 = 25,200.00
Five-day training	6	6 × 11,200 = 67,200.00	6 × 6,300 = 37,800.00

Rates shown are those in force from 1 July 2026. OCEO always uses the current rate.

7.5 When an officer is not available

An officer already on an **approved** activity on any of the same days cannot be added, and OCEO tells you why. An officer on a memo still waiting for a decision shows a warning, but can be added. Only the Office of the CEO can override this, with a reason. If you need an officer who is booked, speak to the Office of the CEO.

8. Checking and Submitting

8.1 Previewing the memo

Press **Preview memo**. OCEO builds the memo in the Board's template: TO, FROM, DATE, REF NO and SUBJECT; your sections; Annex A, the Activity Budget Request; and the list of participants. Read it as the CEO will. The total must agree everywhere and the budget line must be named.

If anything required is missing, OCEO lists it and will not let you submit until it is fixed.

8.2 Submitting for review

1. Press **Submit for review**.
2. Choose who reviews it: the **Assistant Chief of Staff** or the **Chief of Staff**.
3. Confirm. The memo moves to the **Awaiting review and decision** tab and is locked.

> **Warning:** Check the memo carefully first. A draft can be thrown away with **Discard draft**, but a submitted memo is never deleted.

8.3 Signing as acting Head

If you are acting in the role, tick **I am signing in an acting capacity** when you submit. The memo then reads "Ag." before your designation, for example "Ag. Manager, ICT". Your record on the staff list does not change.

9. When a Memo Is Returned

A reviewer or the CEO may return your memo for correction. You get an alert and an email, and the memo appears on the **Returned for correction** tab.

1. Open the memo and read the comment at the top. It says what must change.
2. Press **Edit memo**, or open **Team and costs**, and make the changes.
3. Press **Preview memo** to check it again.
4. Press **Resubmit for review**. It goes back to the same office.

> **Tip:** If a comment is not clear, call the reviewer before you change the memo. A second return costs more time than a short call.

10. After the CEO Decides

10.1 When the memo is approved

You are alerted and the memo moves to **Approved and authorised**. On approval the CEO instructs Finance to process the imprest and Supply Chain to procure the tickets, and may instruct other departments, for example Administration for a vehicle. You are told when each instruction is done, with its reference, such as the imprest or LPO number.

From the start date the memo shows **In progress**, and after the end date **Completed**. Your report is then due.

10.2 When the memo is declined

The memo moves to the **Declined** tab with the CEO's reason. A declined memo is final. If the activity is still needed, prepare a new memo that answers the reason.

10.3 Changes after approval

If the dates, the team or the costs must change after approval, speak to the Office of the CEO first. Larger changes go back to the CEO for a new decision. If an officer is needed elsewhere, only the Office of the CEO can recall or release them.

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11. Reporting After the Activity

11.1 When the report is due

The report is due **7 working days after the end date**. OCEO records whether it came in on time, from the date it was first received.

11.2 Submitting the report

1. Open the memo and press **Submit activity report**.
2. Write **What the activity achieved**, the **Key findings** and your **Recommendations**.
3. Attach the report document.
4. Under each cost line, type the amount actually spent. Type 0 for anything not used, such as DSA for an officer who did not travel.
5. Press **Submit report**.

> **Important:** The amounts you enter count as spent against your budget straight away, so take them from Finance's records.

11.3 If the report is returned

Press **Correct and resubmit the report**, make the change asked for and submit it again. When the Office of the CEO accepts the report, the activity is closed and nothing on it can change.

12. Asking an Officer to Prepare a Memo

You can ask an officer on your staff list to draft a memo for you. They do not need an account. The memo stays yours: you check it and decide whether it goes for review.

12.1 Sending the request

1. On **Activity memos** press **Ask an officer to prepare a memo**.
2. Choose the officer and say what the memo is for.
3. Choose how many days the link works, up to 30, and press **Send the link**.

12.2 What the officer does

The officer opens the link and asks for a six-digit code, which is sent to their email or mobile on the staff list. With the code they can open that one memo only. They fill it in, add the team and costs, and send it to you.

12.3 Checking what they send

Open it from the **Prepared by officers** tab. Then either:

- submit it for review as in Section 8, when it is ready;
- press **Return to the officer** with a comment, and they receive a new link to correct it; or
- press **Decline** if the memo is not needed.

While the officer has the memo, you cannot edit it. To stop a link at once, press **Revoke** on the memo requests list.

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13. When the CEO Instructs Your Department

When the CEO approves a memo, the CEO may instruct your department to act on it: Finance to process the imprest, Supply Chain to procure the tickets, or any department with a written instruction. You then see **Instructions** in the menu, with a count of those still open.

1. Open the instruction. It shows the reference, dates, places, team and the CEO's note, and for Finance and Supply Chain the cost lines you act on.
2. Press **Acknowledge** so the Office of the CEO knows you have it.
3. When it is done, press **Mark as done** and type the reference, such as the imprest or LPO number.

The Office of the CEO and the memo's department are told at once. Once the memo is approved, you can also read it and its documents, but not change anything on it.

Appendix A: The Activity Memos Tabs

Tab	What is there
Drafts	Memos you started and have not submitted.
Prepared by officers	Memos officers are preparing for you, or have sent to you.
Returned for correction	Memos sent back to you. These need you.
Awaiting review and decision	Memos with the reviewers or the CEO.
Approved and authorised	Approved memos, including those whose report is due.
Declined	Memos the CEO declined, with the reason.
All	Every memo of your department.

Appendix B: Checklists

Before you submit a memo
☐ REF NO and date issued are filled in
☐ Dates, number of days and locations are right
☐ The budget line is chosen and the balance covers the total
☐ Every officer is on the team with the right role, and a team lead is named
☐ Tickets, fuel, vehicle hire and other costs are added
☐ The preview reads well and the total agrees everywhere
☐ "Acting capacity" is ticked if you are acting in the role

Before you submit a report
☐ It is within 7 working days of the end date
☐ What was achieved, the findings and the recommendations are written
☐ The report document is attached
☐ The actual amount is entered on every cost line, with 0 for anything not used

Appendix C: Common Questions

Question	Answer
I cannot add an officer to my team.	They are on another approved activity on those days, or they are not on the staff list. Read the message beside their name.
The memo shows no budget allocation.	Your workplan and budget for the year is not approved yet, or the line you chose is not in it.
Submit for review is refused.	Something required is missing, often the REF NO, the date issued or the team. OCEO lists what to fix.
I made a mistake after submitting.	Ask the reviewer to return the memo to you so you can correct it.
The DSA looks wrong.	Check the officer's job grade on the staff list and the number of days on the memo.
I did not receive the alert email or SMS.	Check spam, and that your email and mobile on the staff list are right. The bell in OCEO always shows your alerts.
I am locked out.	Use **Forgot password?**. Resetting your password unlocks your account.
My email or mobile number has changed.	Ask Human Resources or the System Administrator to update the staff list.
I am leaving the role or going on leave.	Tell the Office of the CEO. Your role can be handed to a successor from today or from a later date. Your memos stay with the department.

Appendix D: Getting Help

For	Contact
Signing in, passwords and accounts	The System Administrator (ICT)
A memo, a review comment or a decision	The Office of the CEO: the Chief of Staff or the Assistant Chief of Staff
Officers missing or wrong on the staff list	Human Resources
Budget lines, allocations and adjustments	The Office of the CEO

> **Tip:** When you ask for help, give the memo reference, and say what you pressed and what you saw. A screenshot helps. Never send your password to anyone, including ICT.